BAYES IN CONFIRMATORY CLINICAL DRUG DEVELOPMENT

Evidence, Decisions and Rules of Engagement

From assumptions and model risk to credible decisions

Hybrid and F2F at Biozentrum Basel, Hörsaal U1.101. Please register here (online free, f2f €60)

An interactive workshop presenting

i. emerging thinking on how Bayes can contribute to confirmatory evidence and
ii. a proposed workflow to facilitate regulatory assessment within a recently proposed framework.
Speakers will lay out positions, illustrate them through case studies;
participants will provide feedback on whether the proposed framework can provide value.

Rather than rehearse Bayesian-versus-frequentist positions, the workshop invites participants to judge where risk lies, which evidence would change their assessment, which themes deserve regulator–sponsor discussion, and, importantly, which concrete actions we can align on that can move the needle towards greater acceptability of Bayes in confirmatory drug development.

TIME (all times shown in 24-h format)	SESSION	FORMAT
14:00–14:10 CET 08:00–08:10 EST	**Welcome** *Lilla di Scala (J&J, BBS President), Anna Wiksten (BMS, EFSPI President)* **Framing the challenge: What are we trying to achieve? How will we get there?** *Kaspar Rufibach (Merck KGaA), Mike Krams (Berry Consultants)*	Welcome + poll
14:10–14:30 CET 08:10–08:30 EST	**Assumptions, Modeling and Risks:** **Decisions and consequences in confirmatory drug development** *Tobias Mielke, Vlad Dragalin (J&J)*	Keynote
14:30–14:50 CET 08:30–08:50 EST	**Paving a path towards broader acceptability of Bayes in drug development** i. Unit of confirmatory evidence – *Roger Lewis (UCLA, Berry Consultants)* ii. Workflow – *Mike Krams*	Report
14:50–15:20 CET 08:50–09:20 EST	**An introduction to ICH M15** *Kristin Karlsson (SMPA & EMA MWP vice-chair)* **Utilizing ICH M15 to support Bayesian design submissions** **Example: Belimumab in pediatric SLE** *Nicky Best (GSK)*	Keynote
15:20–15:50 CET 09:20–09:50 EST	**Case studies** *Scott Berry, Kert Viele (Berry Consultants), Jürgen Hummel (Cytel)* i. without borrowing ii. with borrowing from external data (population, treatment effect)	Presentation + audience votes
15:50–16:20 CET 09:50–10:20 EST	**BREAK**	
16:20–17:30 CET 10:20–11:30 EST	**Vignettes: Bayesian approaches in confirmatory clinical drug development** *i. How will drugs be approved in 2036?* *ii. What would it take to establish broad acceptability of Bayesian approaches?* *iii. How do we get there?* ***One recommendation*** *on what we can do now.* David Spiegelhalter (University of Cambridge), John Scott (FDA), Kristin Karlsson, Lisa LaVange (former Chair of Biostatistics at UNC), Tobias Fellinger (AGES & EMA MWP), Scott Berry, Franz König (MedUni Vienna), Vlad Dragalin, David Wright (AZ), Nicky Best, Roger Lewis, Andy Grieve (King's College London, Weatherden)	Vignettes 5 min, 1 slide per speaker + Call to action
17:30–17:50 CET 11:30–11:50 EST	**Looking Back into the Future: Totality of evidence - how did we get there?** We are in 2036. What will the drug approval process look like? Looking back 10 years into the past, what actionable recommendations would we have given to an audience in 2026? *Moderators: Mike Krams, Kaspar Rufibach*	Panel discussion
17:50–18:00 CET 11:50–12:00 EST	**The Basel verdict**	Repeat poll + close